

VERIFICATION INFRASTRUCTURE FOR THE SOCIAL SECTOR

We make social outcomes auditable.

Saudi Arabia's social sector grew ninefold in under a decade. Almost none of it can prove what it achieved.

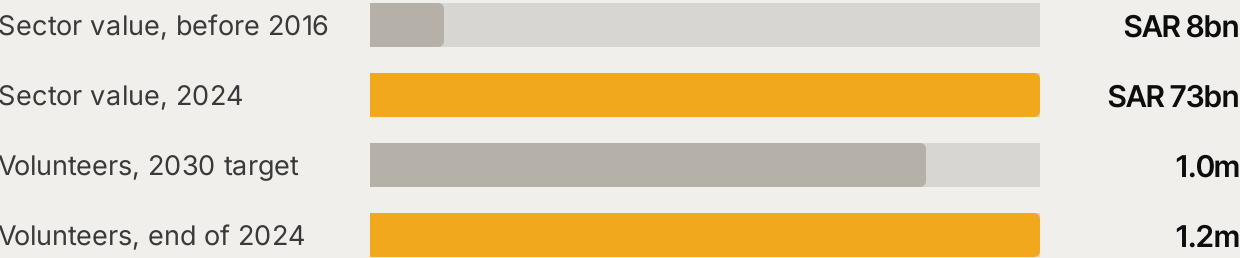
Aimen Rafiq, Founder
Women-led · Pakistan and Saudi Arabia
jointorchbearer.com

WHAT WE DO

**We design social programmes,
run them in hard places, and
produce evidence that holds up
to an auditor.**

Plenty of organisations can do the first two. The third one is scarce, and it is the one that regulators, funders and disclosure rules are all converging on.

A sector scaled ninefold. Its measurement did not.



The Kingdom hit its 2030 volunteering target six years early and grew the sector's value by roughly nine times.

Every one of those headline figures counts an input. Riyals committed. Organisations registered. Volunteers signed up.

None of them says what changed for anybody. The regulator has now shifted its own strategy from growing the sector to professionalising it.

Sources: National Center for Non-Profit Sector 2025 annual report, via Saudi Press Agency (spa.gov.sa/en/N2321543) and Arab News (arabnews.pk/node/2649855). Vision 2030, National Center for Non-Profit Sector Strategy. Bars scaled within each pair.

WHY NOW

Four things became true at the same time.

2025

Saudi disclosure rules became binding for green and sustainability-linked debt issuers, after voluntary guidelines in 2019 and a Tadawul framework in 2021

94

Listed companies published sustainability reports in 2024, roughly 65% of the top 100 by revenue, most of them voluntarily

278Mt

Annual CO₂ reduction committed under the Saudi Green Initiative by 2030, with net zero by 2060

5%

Vision 2030 target for the third sector's share of GDP, against 1.55% today

Environmental commitments already carry numbers. Social commitments do not. As ISSB-aligned standards move through SOCPA and assurance gets closer, every organisation running social programmes for a Saudi corporate is about to be asked a question it cannot currently answer.

Sources: Saudi Exchange ESG Disclosure Guidelines. Grant Thornton Saudi Arabia, "ESG reporting in Saudi Arabia: preparing for IFRS S1 and S2 adoption". Saudi Green Initiative, greeninitiatives.gov.sa. Vision 2030 National Center for Non-Profit Sector Strategy. No mandatory ISSB adoption date has been confirmed.

THE INSIGHT WE ARE BETTING ON

Carbon has a unit. Social has none, so it gets reported in proxies.

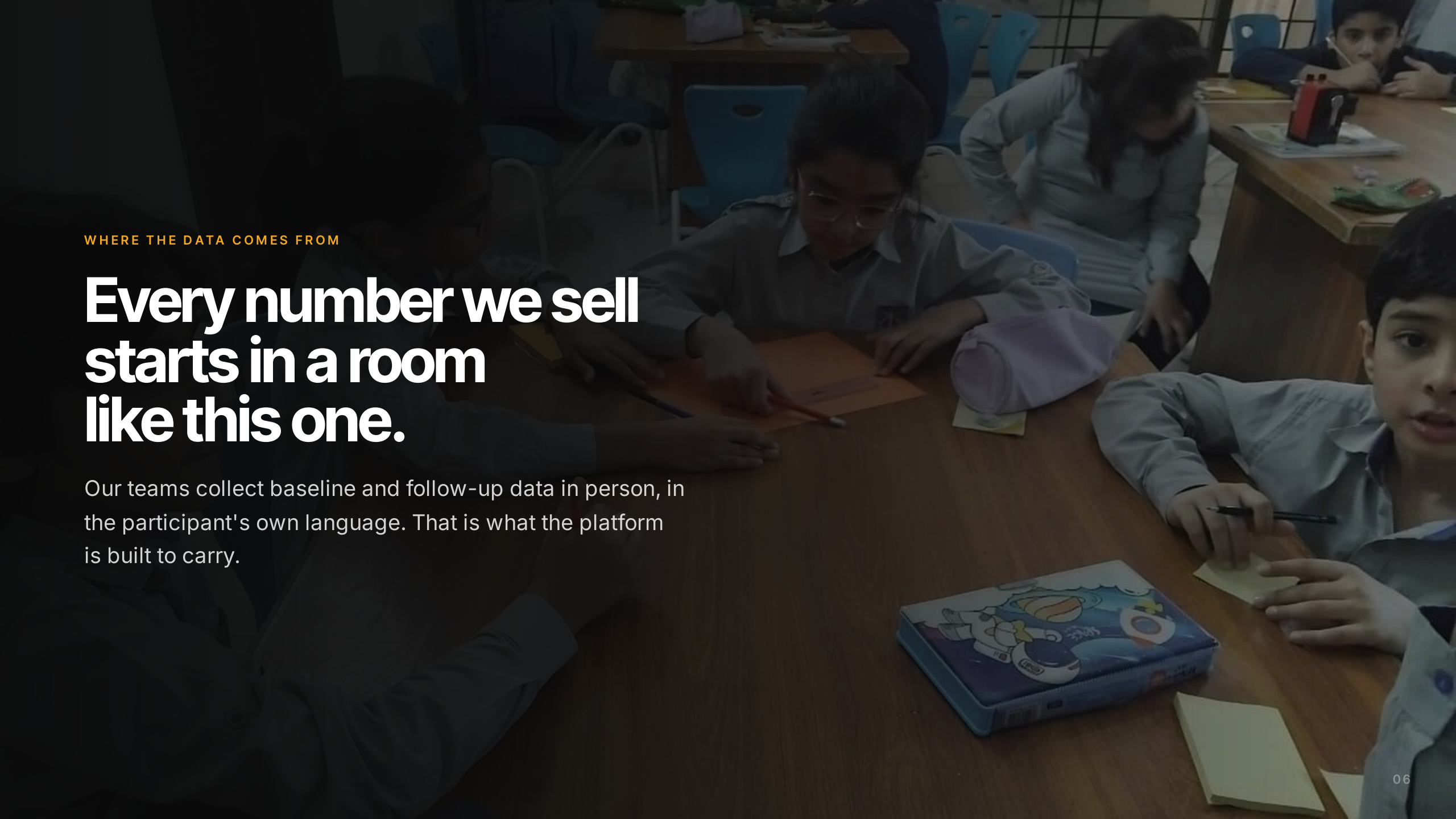
PILLAR	COMMON UNIT	WHAT GETS REPORTED
Environmental	tCO ₂ e	An outcome
Governance	Structural facts	Verifiable
Social	None	Training hours. People reached.

Training hours are an input. A policy is an intention. "People reached" is an activity dressed up as a result.

And none of it can be fixed afterwards. **A programme that ran for three years without a baseline cannot be given one in year four.**

So this is a **delivery** problem, not a reporting problem. Software alone will not solve it. Software built by people who deliver might.

On the absence of a standardised social metric: Dalberg, "Measuring the S in ESG". Treelynk, "Social KPIs and measurement challenges", on proxy indicators that record activity rather than outcomes.



WHERE THE DATA COMES FROM

Every number we sell starts in a room like this one.

Our teams collect baseline and follow-up data in person, in the participant's own language. That is what the platform is built to carry.

WHAT WE ARE BUILDING

Torchbearer **Verify**

A platform that carries a social programme from design through to audit-grade evidence, with the field capability to make the data real rather than assumed.

DESIGN

Indicator builder

Programmes built against named SDG targets and Vision 2030 pillars, with baselines and instruments generated before delivery starts, because afterwards is too late.

DELIVER

Field capture

Offline-capable collection through local partners, with attrition and exclusions recorded as they happen rather than reconstructed at the end.

VERIFY

Evidence pack

Raw instruments, method notes and every adjustment, assembled so a third party can rebuild the result without talking to us. Formatted for disclosure.

Written and published. Not yet software.

01 Scope

Establish what is true before designing anything, including an explicit list of what will not be measurable.

02 Design

A causal chain with an indicator on every link. Nothing is procured until cost per outcome is stated.

03 Deliver

Execution through local organisations and locally recruited teams, capturing data as the work happens.

04 Measure

Baseline at intake, endline at a fixed interval, same instrument, same population. Attrition published.

05 Verify

An evidence trail complete enough that a sceptic can disagree with us using our own data.



Not an idea on a napkin.



Session delivery in schools



Community workshop, Punjab



Education materials in use



Household engagement

11

Published analytical papers, every figure cited and linked to source

5

Stage method framework, published in full with standards attached

6

SDG targets mapped to Vision 2030 and Saudi Green Initiative pillars

2

Delivery geographies, Pakistan and Saudi Arabia

TO COMPLETE BEFORE SUBMISSION. Programme figures: districts, dates, participants enrolled, delivery partners, results measured so far. Misk accepts idea and prototype stage, so this is not disqualifying, but one real number is worth more than a page of method.

Most people building this have never delivered a programme.

Proven where it is hardest

We work in flood-exposed districts of Pakistan, with long supply chains and populations on no distribution list. A method that survives there transfers downwards in difficulty.

The method is public

Five stages with standards attached, published in full alongside eleven sourced papers. We publish what underperformed. Nobody else in this category does.

Women-led throughout

In a category whose participants are women and girls, that is an operational advantage before it is anything else. It decides who talks to us at follow-up.

Consultancies write frameworks they have never had to execute. Implementers deliver without measuring. We are building from the only position that produces a working product, which is having done both.

Sized from public figures, with the assumption exposed.

	BASIS	VALUE
Sector	Saudi non-profit sector value, 2024	SAR 73bn
Addressable	If measurement and verification runs at 1 to 3% of programme spend	SAR 0.7 to 2.2bn
Adjacent	Listed companies already publishing sustainability reports	94
Beachhead	Corporates holding a social mandate with no delivery or measurement capability	Entry point

This is not "social impact measurement" in the abstract. It is a dated obligation landing on a specific set of organisations.

- Corporates facing disclosure with a social pillar they cannot evidence
- Non-profits inside the regulator's professionalisation agenda
- Funds needing results in a defined framework
- Government entities building capability to keep in-house

Sector value: National Center for Non-Profit Sector, 2024. Disclosure count: Saudi Exchange reporting via Spectreco analysis. The 1 to 3% band is our own assumption, not a published figure. It is stated so it can be argued with, which is the standard we hold our programme numbers to.

BUSINESS MODEL

Revenue from the first engagement, not the first grant.

LAND

Design engagement

Fixed scope and fixed price: programme design, measurement plan, indicator mapping, cost per outcome. The client can then deliver it with anyone.

EXPAND

Platform licence

Per-programme subscription to Verify. The recurring line, and the reason this is a venture rather than a consultancy.

DEEPEN

Delivery and verification

Full execution through local partners, or independent verification of programmes already running. Higher value, and it keeps the product honest.

The wedge is the design engagement. It is small, quick and it produces the document that makes the platform obviously necessary. Nobody buys measurement software until they have seen what their current numbers cannot survive.

Everyone does two of the three.

WHO	DESIGN	DELIVER	VERIFY	WHERE IT BREAKS
Global consultancies	Yes	No	Partly	Frameworks written by people who never had to execute them
Implementing NGOs	Partly	Yes	No	Measurement designed after delivery, so it cannot be repaired
ESG reporting software	No	No	Partly	Aggregates whatever it is given. Cannot fix a missing baseline
Assurance firms	No	No	Yes	Arrive at the end, when the evidence either exists or does not
Torchbearer	Yes	Yes	Yes	Built outwards from field delivery, which is the only order that works

The defensible part is not the software. It is that the software encodes a method proven in the hardest delivery conditions we could find, and that we keep delivering, so it stays true.

Publish the problem. Sell the fix.

01 Inbound from published analysis

Eleven sourced papers on exactly the problems our buyers have, already public and already indexed.

02 The free diagnostic

Four questions applied to a prospect's existing impact report. It reliably fails, using material they published themselves.

03 Land with a design engagement

Fixed price, weeks rather than months, and it produces the artefact that makes the platform necessary.

Why Saudi Arabia first

- A regulator publicly prioritising measurable impact, with budget behind it
- Disclosure obligations arriving on a known trajectory
- Corporates with mandate and money but no delivery capability
- Vision 2030 gives every buyer a framework to report into, and we already map to it

Why Pakistan stays

It is the proving ground. Delivery economics there make rigorous measurement affordable at a scale where it would otherwise be a luxury.

What we will have built by 2 January.

PHASE	WEEKS	WHAT WE DO	DELIVERABLE
Ideate	1 to 3	Validate the measurement gap with 25 or more Saudi buyers across corporates, non-profits and funds. Test whether they will pay to fix it, and at what price.	Validated problem and pricing
Build	4 to 7	MVP of the indicator builder and evidence-pack generator, tested against a live Maahwari dataset rather than a synthetic one.	Working MVP
Test to sell	8 to 9	Run the free diagnostic with named prospects. Convert two into paid design engagements.	First paying customers
Grow	10 plus	MISA licensing route, Saudi entity, and a sales motion we can repeat.	In market

We are applying at the right stage. The method is finished and public. The product is not built. That is what a pre-accelerator is for, and we are not pretending otherwise.



Aimen Rafiq

Founder, Torchbearer

Torchbearer is **women-led from the founder to the field teams** who run the sessions and collect the follow-up data.

In a category whose participants are women and girls, that is why we can collect data other organisations cannot, and why our follow-up response rates hold.



DELIVERY IN PRACTICE

The work already runs. The product is what is missing.

Digital and financial literacy training, delivered to women by women. Sessions like this are where baseline and follow-up data gets collected, and they are the reason we know what a measurement tool has to survive.

Ten weeks at Launchpad turns that field practice into something a Saudi institution can license.

**The Kingdom decided
its social sector
should be professional.
Somebody has to
build the evidence.**